

FATHER SOLANUS, NOTEBOOK No. 2

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(cont'd.)

determined to bear the burdens of the holy state they enter; remembering that their dutys and privileges are one and the same and must be taken as such if peace is to reign in the individual soul, in the family, in human society. How is it that there are so many unhappy unions in the holy state of matrimony? How is it that where peace should abide and conjugal love should reign (to the edification of the earth and the delight of Heaven) that there is so much discontent, so much suspicion, so much hatred even and quarreling? How is it the divorces in our own country alone are running away into the hundreds of thousands? - one single divorce is a blot of scandal in a community? Why is it? Is it not because of the levity with which so many of our young people prepare for and enter marriage? They worship at the shrine of amusement and pleasure while preparing, dreaming of nothing else; casting away the thought of duty and obligation which indeed is so grave and so manifold --- They trust to material advantages and to natural attractions in creatures, forgetting the Creator of all beauty and joy and holy pleasure; and how can they but be disappointed? But alas, the worst of it is not for themselves but for innocent parties, for poor children that grow up practically without a father or a mother and in cases of mixed marriages without definite religion. But the marriages are not all so discouraging. Thank God there are many still who do prepare for this holy state and embrace it as God-fearing people ought to do. Many marriages in the Church where the parties begin their new state at the steps of God's altar with the blessing of the Church and of God upon them, with Jesus in their hearts. Such marriages are an edification to the parties themselves, a delight to friends, a joy to the angels and surely as such weddings the Mother of Jesus is undoubtedly there also. For whene Jesus is in our hearts, Mary will be not far away. -- +